

Nikita Iudenzkov

Senior Python Backend Engineer

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Summary

Senior Python backend engineer with 7+ years building production systems from the ground up - crypto trading platforms, social networks, and enterprise LLM gateways. Author of PySentry, an open-source Python security scanner written in Rust with 640k+ downloads, adopted by Google's Firebase Genkit SDK and featured on the PythonBytes podcast.

Skills

Languages: Python, Rust

Backend: FastAPI, Django, DRF, SQLAlchemy, Celery, LangChain/LangGraph, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ

Cloud & Infra: AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB, S3, SQS, Cognito), Docker, Kubernetes, Microservices, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Languages

Russian: Native

English: Professional working proficiency

Experience

Open-Source Author & Contract Backend Engineer, Independent Development Feb 2025 – present

- Built **PySentry**, an open-source Python dependency vulnerability scanner written in Rust - 640,000+ downloads, adopted in production by Google's Firebase Genkit SDK, OVD-Info, and Activist.org, and featured on the PythonBytes podcast
- Architected and built, on contract for an enterprise client, an LLM gateway on FastAPI with control plane / data plane split: stateless router proxying LLM providers and a platform API handling RBAC, atomic per-request billing of LLM usage against user credits, Kafka event bus with Outbox pattern, and Redis Lua-based rate limiting
- Delivered, on contract for a sports-tech company, the backend-to-ML integration layer for a football-video analytics platform - orchestrated a multi-stage Celery pipeline, handed artifacts between the backend and ML services over S3-compatible object storage, and built a QA gate that flagged ML-vs-expected conflicts for review before results were persisted

Senior Python Backend Engineer, Yolllo Mar 2024 – Feb 2025

Visual-content-first social media platform built from scratch

- Orchestrated migration of ~90,000 users and 2TB of content from a legacy platform, reverse-engineering and repairing broken database schemas to ensure data integrity in the new architecture
- Built an automated media processing pipeline with FFmpeg converting uploaded video to .mp4, compressing, and standardizing to 1920x1080 - reducing storage costs and ensuring consistent playback across clients
- Integrated Keycloak as a unified authentication layer across four company services, enabling single sign-on and centralized session management

Senior Python Backend Engineer, Evvve

Sept 2022 – Dec 2023

Professional events platform with social networking and live streaming

- Implemented the core backend: user management, event and attendance flows, social features, and integration with AWS IVS/MediaLive for live streaming
- Architected a real-time chat system as a pair of serverless microservices (REST API + WebSocket) on AWS Lambda and DynamoDB, designed for burst-scaling during virtual conferences

Python Backend Engineer, Skipp

Aug 2021 – Sept 2022

HR tech platform for building and managing remote engineering teams

- Initiated and led the architectural transition from a Django monolith to microservices, decoupling core subsystems to enable independent deployment and reduce release contention
- Drove an incremental migration from Django to FastAPI, modernizing async handling and improving API responsiveness across the platform
- Designed and built a centralized notification service integrating email, SMS, and Slack, replacing ad-hoc notification logic spread across services

Python Backend Engineer, SwapZilla

Feb 2019 – Aug 2021

Cryptocurrency trading platform providing unified access to multiple exchanges and trading tools

- Optimized the balance deposit/withdrawal service listening to blockchain transaction blocks; developed Ethereum support end-to-end
- Built a service pulling real-time market data from exchanges via REST API and WebSockets, feeding the trading UI and order routing

Projects

PySentry [Open-Source Developer]

May 2025 – present

Python dependency vulnerability scanner written in Rust. Compares installed packages against several databases, 15-30x faster than pip-audit.

- 640,000+ downloads, 240+ GitHub stars
- Adopted in production by Google's Firebase Genkit SDK (5.3k+ stars), OVD-Info, and Activist.org. Featured on the PythonBytes podcast.

TutSovet [Project Manager / Team Lead / Backend Developer]

Sept 2019 – Nov 2020

Managed a development team (1 backend, 1 frontend, 1 AI developer) working on a startup - event announcements and a matching app for finding people to attend events with.

- Stack: Python, Django, RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL, Rust (actix-web, diesel-orm), React.js

Space Station 13 [Open-Source Game Developer]

2015 – 2019

- Contributor to /tg/station (1.3k+ stars, 4k+ forks); maintained Russian-speaking community forks with 25+ monthly contributors, built anti-multi-account protection, and hosted own servers. C, SQL, JavaScript, Python, Rust.